Ans. (d) : The history of Ashoka is known to us mainly from his inscriptions. More than 40 records have been received so far. For the first time the name Ashoka is found in the Maski inscription. This inscription is located in Raichur district of Karnataka state. Its name is also found in Gurjara inscriptions.The Kalsi inscription is located in Dehradun in the state of Uttarakhand. This inscription is in Brahmi script. It was discovered in 1837. The Ashokan inscription was first read by James Princep in 1837. The Rummindei short column inscription was discovered in 1896 by Fehrer in the Terai of Nepal. This small inscription shows that Ashoka visited here in the 20th year of his rule and abolished the tax called Bali and reduced the land tax from 1/6 to 1/8. The Maski inscription was discovered by Borden in 1915.

8. The following map shows four of the sixteen mahajanapadas that existed in ancient India:



The places marked A, B, C and D respectively are

(a) Matsya, Cedi, Kosla, Anga
(b) Surasena, Avanti, Vastsa, Magadha
(c) Matsya, Avanti, Vatsa, Anga
(d) Surasena, Cedi, Kosala, Magadha

Ans. (c) : Matsya, Avanti, Vatsa, Anga

9. In the Mahayana Buddhism, the Bodhisatya Avalokitesvar was also known as:

(a) Vajrapani (b) Manusri
(c) Padmapani (d) Maitreya

Ans. (c) : Padmapani is another name in Sanskrit for Bhodisattva Avalokiteswara, who represents the compassion. The glit bronze image of the Bhodisattva Padmapani [Lotus bearer] shows him as a graceful princely figure, endowed with special attributes symbolizing his power and functions. He is described as the embodiment of the pure, impartial and limitless compassion.

10. The silver coins issued by the Guptas were called:

(a) Rupaka (b) Karshapana
(c) Dinara (d) Pana

Ans. (a) : The coin issued by the Guptas were mainly of silver and gold.
Silver coin was called Rupaka based on Sakas of Ujjain weighing 32-46 grans. 6 Gold coins are known as Dinnars.

11. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer:

List-I (Author)	List-II (Text)
A. Varahamihira	1. Prabandha-Chintamani
B. Visakhadatta	2. Mrichchha-Katikam
C. Sudraka	3. Brihat-Samhita
D. Bilhana	4. Devi-Chandraguptam
	5. Vikramankadeva-charita

Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	3	4	5	2
(b)	3	4	2	5
(c)	5	3	4	1
(d)	1	3	5	2

Ans. (b) : The correct match is mentioned as below:

Varahamihira	–	Brihat-Samhita
Visakhadatta	–	Devi-Chandraguptam
Sudraka	–	Mrichhkatikam
Bilhana	–	Vikramankadeva Charita

12. Which one of the following was a corporation of merchants in ancient India?

(a) Chaturvedimanagalam
(b) Parishad
(c) Ashtadikgaja
(d) Manigrama

Ans. (d) : Manigramam refers to a medieval merchant guild, organized by itinerant ethnic Indian traders, primarly active in the south India. The manigramam played a major role in the commercial activities of the region. The manigramam is found both in the port-towns and in the hinter land trade centres.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY

13. After consolidating his power, Balban assumed the grand title of:

(a) Tute-i-Hind (b) Kaisr-i-Hind
(c) Zil-i-Ilahi (d) Din-i-IIahi

Ans. (c) : Ghiyasuddin Balban of the Balbani dynasty abolished the group of forty Turkish chieftains established by Iltutmish. Balban reorganized a new military department 'Diwan-i-Arz', he followed a strict 'iron and blood' policy towards his opponents. Balban was the first Sultan of the Delhi Sultanate who explained his kingship theory in detail. After consolidating his power, Balban assumed the title of 'Zil -i-Ilahi'. Amir Khusro was the court poet during the time of Alauddin Khilji. Amir Khusrau was the best

Indian poet of Persian language. He was born in Patiyali village of Etah (Uttar Pradesh). He was a disciple of Nizamuddin Auliya. He was the first Indian writer to use Hindi words and idioms. Amir Khusrau was known as Tuti-e-Hind (Parrot of India).
Abul Fazl was the head priest of Din-i-Ilahi. Among the important Hindu mansabdars, Birbal accepted this religion.
The British Government had honoured Mahatma Gandhi with the title 'Kaiser-e-Hind'. It was returned by Gandhiji in response to Jalliwalabagh massacre.

14. The head of the military department under the recognised central machinery of administration during Akbar's reign was

(a) Diwan (b) Mir Bakshi
(c) Mir Saman (d) Bakshi

Ans. (b) : The head of the military department under the reorganized central machinery of administration during Akbar's reign was Mir Bakshi, appointed from among the leading nobles of the court. The Mir Bakshi was in charge of intelligence gathering, and also made recommendations to the emperor for military appointments and promotions.

15. Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other labelled as Reason (R) :

Assertion (A) : The sponsor and the most prominent figure of the Chishti order of Sufis in India is Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti.

Reason (R) : The Chishti order takes its name from a village Chishti in Ajmer.

In the context of the above two statements, which one of the following is correct?

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
(b) Both A and R are true but R is NOT a correct explanation of A
(c) A is true but R is false
(d) A is false but R is true

Ans. (c) : The Chishti order is a Sufi order within the mystic branches of Islam which was founded in Chishti, a small town near Herat, Afghanistan about 930 CE. The order was founded by Abu Ishaq Shami ("the Syrian"). The most famous of the Chishti saints is Moinuddin Chishti popularly known as Gharib Nawaz meaning "Benefactor of the Poor" who settled in Ajmer, India.

16. The Medieval Indian writer who refers to the discovery of America is:

(a) Malik Muhammand Jayasi
(b) Amir Khusrau
(c) Raskhan
(d) Abul Fazl

Ans. (d) : Abul Fazl's was court poet. Who wrote important texts like Akbarnama and Ain-e-Akbari. It was also included in the nine gems of Akbar's court. He was the chief advisor and secretary of Akbar.He had ample knowledge of history, philosophy and literature. Abul Fazl was the chief priest of Akbar's Din-i-Ilahi religion. He has mentioned the discovery of America in his works. In 1602, on the instructions of Jahangir, Abul Fazl, who was coming from the south to Agra, was assassinated by a Bundela chieftain. Amir Khusro was the best Indian poet of Persian language. He was born in Etah (Uttar Pradesh). Amir Khusrau's childhood name was Abul Hasan. He was a disciple of Nizamuddin Auliya. It was patronized by the Sultans from Balban to the time of Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq. In the field of music, he invented the sitar by combining the Iranian tambura and the Indian veena. Raskhan, a contemporary of Vitthalnath, was a Muslim poet.He was engrossed in devotion to Krishna. His two main works on Krishna are Premvatika, Sujan Raskhan. Malik Muhammad Jayasi is the representative poet of the Premashrayi branch of Bhaktikal. Sheikh Mehndi and Mubarak Shah wereinitiation gurus. Their main works are - Padmavat, Akhravat, Aakhri Kalam etc.

MODERN HISTORY

17. Match the List-I with List-II ad select the correct answer:

List-I	List-II
A. Butler Committee Report	1. Jallianwala Bagh massacre
B. Hartog Committee Report	2. Relationship between the Indian states and paramount power
C. Hunter Inquiry Committee Report	3. Working of Dyarchy as laid down in the Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms
D. Muddiman Committee Report	4. The growth of education in British India ad potentialities of its further progress

Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	3	2	1	4
(b)	1	4	2	3
(c)	2	1	3	4
(d)	2	4	1	3

Ans. (d) : During the tenure of Lord Irwin (1926-31 AD), the Butler Committee (Harcourt Butler) was formed in 1927 to examine the relations between the native states and the British Indian government and suggest ways to establish peaceful relations between them. In 1929, during the tenure of Lord Irwin (1926-31 AD), the Indian Statutory Commission (Philip Hartog)